METRIC

MIL-S-20552B
7 June 1983
SUPERSEDING
MIL-S-20552A
24 July 1962

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

SODIUM AZIDE, TECHNICAL (METRIC)

This specification is approved for use by all
Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers two grades of sodium azide.

1.2 Classification. Sodium azide shall be of the following grades as specified (see 6.2):

Grade A - Bacteriostatic agent,
Grade B - Lead azide intermediate.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. Unless otherwise specified, the following specifications, standards, and handbooks of the issue listed in that issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) specified in the solicitation form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

: Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed: to: Commander, US Army Armament Research and Development Command, ATTN: DRDAR-TSC-S, Aberdeen Proving Ground, MD 21010 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 6810

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SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

NN-P-71	-	Pallets, Material Handling, Wood, Stringer Construction, 2-Way and 4-Way (Partial)
PPP-B-585	-	Boxes, Wood, Wirebound
PPP-B-601	-	Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood
PPP-B-621	-	Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-C-2020	-	Chemicals, Liquid, Dry, and Paste: Packaging Of
PPP-F-320	-	Fiberboard: Corrugated and Solid, Sheet Stock (Container Grade), and Cut Shapes

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-147	-	Palletized Unit Loads

2.1.2 Other Government documents. The following other Government documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

CODE OF FEDERAL REGULATIONS (CFR)

49 CFR 171 to 179	-	Department of Transportation Hazardous Materials Regulations

(The Code of Federal Regulations is available from the Superintendent of Documents, US Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402. Orders for the above publication should cite "49 CFR 171 to 179".)

(Copies of specifications, standards, handbooks, drawings, and publications required by manufacturers in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. The issues of the documents which are indicated as DoD adopted shall be the issue listed in the current DoDISS and the supplement thereto, if applicable.

UNIFORM FREIGHT CLASSIFICATION RULES

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

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NATIONAL MOTOR FREIGHT CLASSIFICATION RULES

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, NW, Washington, DC 20036.)

ASTM STANDARDS

D1193 - Reagent Water

(Application for copies should be addressed to ASTM, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

(Industry association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, the text of this specification shall take precedence.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Appearance. Sodium azide shall be in the form of white, free-flowing to partially reagglomerated crystals, free from visible contamination when tested as specified in 4.2.4.1.

3.2 Chemical characteristics. Sodium azide shall conform to the chemical characteristics of table I when tested as specified therein.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Quality conformance inspection.

4.2.1 Lotting. A lot shall consist of the sodium azide of one grade, produced by one manufacturer, at one plant, from the same materials, and under essentially the same manufacturing conditions provided the operation is continuous. In the event the process is a batch operation, each batch shall constitute a lot (see 6.3).

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TABLE I. Chemical characteristics

Characteristic	Percent by weight		Test paragraph
	Grade A	Grade B	
Assay (as NaN_3), minimum	99.0	99.0	4.2.4.2
Alkalinity (as NaOH), maximum	0.3	0.3	4.2.4.3
Insoluble matter, maximum	0.2	---	4.2.4.4
Chlorides, maximum	None by test	None by test	4.2.4.5
Sulfates (as Na_2SO_4), maximum	0.1	0.1	4.2.4.6
Nitrates, maximum	None by test	---	4.2.4.7
Iron, maximum	0.05	---	4.2.4.8
Moisture, maximum	0.5	---	4.2.4.9

4.2.2 Sampling.

4.2.2.1 For examination of packaging. Sampling shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.2.2.2 For test. See 6.5 for sampling and testing precautions. Sampling shall be conducted in accordance with table II. A representative specimen of approximately 300 grams (g) shall be removed from each sample container and placed in a suitable clean, dry container labeled to identify the lot and container from which it was taken.

TABLE II. Sampling for test

Number of containers in batch or lot	Number of sample containers
3 to 150	3
151 to 1,200	5
1,201 to 7,000	8
7,001 to 20,000	10
Over 20,000	20

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4.2.3 Inspection procedure.

4.2.3.1 For examination of packaging. The sample unit shall be one filled unit or shipping container, as applicable, ready for shipment. Sample unit and shipping containers shall be examined for the following defects using an AQL of 2.5 percent defective:

(a) Contents per containers not as specified
(b) Container not as specified
(c) Container closure not as specified
(d) Container damaged or leaking
(e) Fiberboard liner, pads, or partitions missing or not as specified (when required)
(f) Marking incorrect, missing, or illegible
(g) Unitization not as specified

4.2.3.2 For test. Each sample specimen taken in 4.2.2.2 shall be tested as specified in 4.2.4. Failure of any test by any specimen shall be cause for rejection of the lot represented.

4.2.4 Tests. See 6.5 for sampling and testing precautions. Water in accordance with ASTM D1193 and reagent grade chemicals shall be used throughout the tests. Where applicable, blank determinations shall be run and corrections applied where significant. All tests shall be performed in a ventilated fume hood. Tests shall be conducted as follows:

4.2.4.1 Appearance. Visually examine the sodium azide for color, form, and evidence of contamination.

4.2.4.2 Assay (as NaN_3).

(a) Ammonium hexa-nitrate cerate solution (approximately 0.1N). Dissolve 170.0 g of ammonium hexa-nitrate cerate (see 6.6) in a mixture of 185.0 milliliters (mL) of concentrated nitric acid and 125.0 mL of water. Stir well. Add 300.0 mL of water containing 12.5 mL of concentrated nitric acid and stir. Using continuous stirring, dilute the solution to 2.50 liters (L). Store the solution in a brown bottle.

(b) Ferrous sulfate solution (0.05N). Carefully add 10 mL of concentrated sulfuric acid to 700 mL of cold water and allow to cool. Add 19.75 g of ferrous ammonium sulfate [$(NH_4)_2SO_4 \cdot FeSO_4 \cdot 6H_2O$], stir until solution is effected, transfer to a 1-L volumetric flask, dilute to the mark with water and mix thoroughly. Store the solution under an inert gas. Use all-glass or saran tubing for connections. To reduce any ferric iron which may be present, pass the solution through a Jones reductor immediately before using this solution.

(c) Ortho-phenanthroline indicator (see 6.7). Dissolve 0.50 g of ferrous sulfate in 50 mL of water and add two drops of concentrated sulfuric acid. Weigh 0.50 g of ortho-phenanthroline and add it to the solution. Add water to make 100.0 mL of solution.

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(d) Standardization of ferrous sulfate solution. Dry approximately 4 g of arsenious oxide (Primary Standard, National Bureau of Standards Certified) for approximately 1 hour at 102.5° ± 2.5°C, and place it in a desiccator to cool. Weigh approximately 2 g of the dried arsenious oxide to an accuracy of 1.0 milligram (mg) and place it in a 500-mL beaker. Add approximately 10 g of sodium hydroxide and 100 mL of water. Stir until solution is effected, warming to not higher than 60°C, if necessary. Transfer the solution into a 1-L volumetric flask and add approximately 300 mL of water and 100 mL of 50-percent sulfuric acid. Dilute to the mark with water and thoroughly agitate the solution. Pipet a 50-mL aliquot of the solution to a 400-mL beaker and add three drops of osmium tetroxide solution (0.250 g of osmium tetroxide dissolved in a sufficient amount of 0.1N sulfuric acid to make 100.0 mL of solution). Add 25.0 mL of ammonium hexa-nitrate cerate solution from a buret, and adjust the volume to approximately 150 mL with water. Add 5.0 mL of concentrated sulfuric acid and two drops of ortho-phenathroline indicator. Titrate the excess cerate with 0.05N ferrous sulfate solution. Run a blank determination using the same quantities of chemicals omitting only the arsenious oxide. Calculate the normality as follows:

$$\text{Normality of } FeSO_4 = \frac{1000W}{49.465\ (X - Y)}$$

where: W = Weight, in grams, of arsenious oxide in aliquot,
X = Milliliters $FeSO_4$ solution required for blank, and
Y = Milliliters $FeSO_4$ solution required for cerate solution in excess of that required for the arsenious oxide.

(e) Procedure. Weigh approximately 2.5 g of the specimen to the nearest 1 mg. Dissolve it in 200 mL of water and transfer the solution to a 250-mL volumetric flask. Dilute the solution to the mark with water and mix it thoroughly. Pipet a 25-mL aliquot of the solution into a 400-mL beaker and slowly add 50.0 mL of 0.1N ammonium hexa-nitrate cerate solution, cooling the mixture in water as the reaction proceeds. When the reaction is completed, adjust the volume to approximately 150 mL with water, and slowly add 5.0 mL of concentrated sulfuric acid. Add two drops of ortho-phenanthroline indicator and titrate the solution with the 0.05N ferrous sulfate solution (pale green to reddish-yellow). Perform a blank determination using the same quantities of chemicals, omitting only the sodium azide. Calculate the percent by weight sodium azide as follows:

$$\text{Percent sodium azide} = \frac{6.5\ (C - D)\ N}{W}$$

where: C = Milliliters ferrous sulfate solution required for blank,
D = Milliliters ferrous sulfate solution required for cerate solution in excess of that required for specimen,
N = Normality of ferrous sulfate solution, and
W = Weight, in grams, of specimen contained in aliquot.

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4.2.4.3 Alkalinity. Weigh approximately 10 g of the specimen to the nearest 0.1 g, place it in a 500-mL Erlenmeyer flask, and dissolve it in approximately 100 mL of freshly boiled water. Using phenolphthalein indicator, rapidly titrate the solution to the neutral point with 0.1N hydrochloric acid. Record the milliliters of acid used for this titration as A. Add 10.00 mL of 0.1N sodium hydroxide and approximately 10 mL of 10-percent barium chloride solution. Allow the mixture to stand for approximately 5 minutes and again titrate the solution with 0.1N hydrochloric acid to the phenolphthalein end-point. Record the milliliters of acid used for this titration as B. Calculate the percent by weight alkalinity as follows:

$$\text{Percent alkalinity} = \frac{4AC + 0.0044\ (10D - BC)}{W}$$

where: A = Milliliters 0.1N hydrochloric acid used in first titration,
B = Milliliters 0.1N hydrochloric acid used in second titration,
C = Normality of hydrochloric acid,
D = Normality of sodium hydroxide, and
W = Weight, in grams, of specimen used.

4.2.4.4 Insoluble matter. Weigh approximately 50 g of the specimen to the nearest 0.1 g and dissolve in approximately 200 mL of water at room temperature. Filter the solution through a tared filtering crucible and wash the precipitate thoroughly with water at room temperature. Place the crucible in an oven at 102° ± 2°C for 4 hours. Remove the crucible from the oven, place it in a desiccator, cool to room temperature, and reweigh the crucible and contents to an accuracy of 0.01 g. Calculate the percent by weight insoluble matter as follows:

$$\text{Percent insoluble matter} = \frac{100\ (B - A)}{W}$$

where: A = Tare weight of crucible, in grams,
B = Weight of crucible and residue, in grams, and
W = Weight of specimen used, in grams.

4.2.4.5 Chlorides. Dissolve 1.00 g of the specimen in 24 mL of water in a 400-mL beaker. Place the beaker in a fume hood and very slowly add approximately 15 mL of 20-percent nitric acid. When effervescence ceases, add 2 mL of a 2.5-percent solution of silver nitrate in water. Perform a blank determination using the same quantities of chemicals and omitting only the sodium axide. Place the sample solutions in separate comparison tubes and observe the turbidities of the solutions. Report the absence of chlorides if the test solution is not more turbid than the blank solution.

4.2.4.6 Sulfates (as Na_2SO_4). Weigh approximately 5 g of the specimen to the nearest 0.1 g, and dissolve in approximately 100 mL of water in a 500-mL Erlenmeyer flask. Place the flask in a fume hood and add approximately 50 mL of dilute hydrochloric acid (1:6). Concentrate the solution by boiling to

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approximately one-half the volume. Add approximately 10 mL of 10-percent barium chloride and allow the mixture to stand overnight. Filter the precipitate using a tared filtering crucible, and wash the precipitate thoroughly with water. Place the crucible in an oven at 102° ± 2°C for 4 hours. Remove the crucible from the oven, place it in a desiccator to cool to room temperature, and reweigh the crucible and contents to the nearest 0.1 mg. Calculate the percent by weight sulfates as follows:

$$\text{Percent sulfates (as } Na_2SO_4) = \frac{60.86\ (B - A)}{W}$$

where: A = Tare weight of crucible, in grams,
B = Weight of crucible and barium sulfate, in grams, and
W = Weight of specimen used, in grams.

4.2.4.7 Nitrates. Add 0.12 g of diphenylamine to 20.0 mL of 95-percent sulfuric acid in a 100-mL beaker and slowly dilute with 20.0 mL of water. Place the beaker in a fume hood and add a few crystals of the specimen. Observe the color of the mixture. Report the specimen as having no nitrates if no blue color is observed.

4.2.4.8 Iron.

(a) Iron standard solution. Dissolve 0.8635 g of ferric ammonium sulfate [$FeNH_4(SO_4)_2.12H_2O$)] in a mixture of 70 mL of water and 5.0 mL of concentrated sulfuric acid. Transfer the solution into a 100-mL volumetric flask and dilute to the mark with water. Thoroughly mix the solution, pipet 10.0 mL into a 1-L volumetric flask, and fill to the mark with water. (This solution contains 0.01 mg of iron per milliliter.)

(b) Procedure. Dissolve 2.000 g of the specimen in 3.0 g of sodium nitrate in approximately 50 mL of water. Filter the solution and wash the filter and any residue sparingly with water. Place the filtrate in a fume hood and cautiously add approximately 10 mL of concentrated hydrochloric acid. When the reaction is complete, evaporate the solution to dryness in the fume hood. Take up the residue in approximately 10 mL of concentrated hydrochloric acid and 1 mL of 3-percent hydrogen peroxide, and again evaporate to dryness in the fume hood. Dissolve the residue in approximately 200 mL of water. Transfer the solution into a 250-mL volumetric flask and fill to the mark with water. Thoroughly mix the solution and transfer 50.0 mL to an identified 100-mL matched comparison tube. Add 10.0 mL of a 10-percent solution of ammonium thiocyanate and 10.0 mL of concentrated hydrochloric acid, and make up to 100.0 mL with water. Run blanks on all of the chemicals used. Compare the colors of the samples to the standard solutions. The color of the sample solution shall be no darker than that of the standard solution.

4.2.4.9 Moisture. Weigh approximately 10 g of the specimen to the nearest 0.01 g in a tared stoppered weighing bottle with the stopper removed, dry the sample for 4 hours in an oven maintained at 102° ± 2°C. At the end of the

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drying period, replace the stopper and place the bottle in a desiccator to cool. After cooling, reweigh the bottle to the nearest 1 mg. Calculate the percent by weight moisture as follows:

$$\text{Percent moisture} = \frac{100\ (A - B)}{A - C}$$

where: A = Weight of bottle and contents before drying, in grams,
B = Weight of bottle and contents after drying, in grams, and
C = Tare weight of bottle, in grams.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Unit packing. Sodium azide shall be unit packed level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. A quantity of 100 (+1 or -0) g of sodium azide shall be unit packed in a wide-mouth glass bottle in accordance with the applicable requirements of PPP-C-2020. The bottle shall conform to group A, class 1, type optional, style 2, grade 1, with screw-cap of PPP-C-186. The bottle shall be closed to a torque within the range specified by the bottle manufacture.

5.1.2 Level C. A specified quantity of sodium azide (see 6.2) shall be unit packed level C in a manner to assure maintenance of its specified quality at time of delivery and for a duration of six months. Unit packing shall be in compliance with Department of Transporation (DOT) regulations and any other applicable regulatory requirements.

5.2 Packing. Sodium azide shall be packed level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Twelve bottles of sodium azide unit packed as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a close fitting wood box, closure end uppermost, in a pattern of 3 rows of 4 bottles. The box shall conform to class 2, style 4, grade A of PPP-B-621; overseas type, style A, B, I or J, grade A of PPP-B-601; or class 3 style optional of PPP-B-585, with wood parts preserved as specified for the grade A box of PPP-B-621. All inside faces of the box shall be lined with fiberboard. Fiberboard pads shall be inserted in the pack where needed to prevent motion of contents. Each bottle shall be placed in a close-fitting full-bottle-height cell formed from half-slotted fiberboard partitions. The pads, fiberboard liner, and partitions shall be formed from fiberboard conforming to grade V3c of PPP-F-320. The box shall be closed and reinforced in accordance with the requirements in the applicable box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Twelve bottles of sodium azide shall be packed level B in the same manner as for level A, except that the box shall be fiberboard conforming to grade V3c of PPP-B-636.

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5.2.3 Level C. Sodium azide, unit packed as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in accordance with DOT regulations, to assure carrier acceptance and safe delivery to destination. Containers shall be in compliance with Uniform Freight Classification (UFC) Rules, National Motor Freight Classification (NMFC) Rules, and the rules of any other common carrier applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Unitization. Uniform quantities per pallet of level A or B packs shall be palletized in accordance with load type 1 of MIL-STD-147, using the soft wood pallet conforming to type IV of NN-P-71. Uniform quantities of level C packs of sodium azide shall be unitized in a manner acceptable to the common carrier, in compliance with UFC and NMFC Rules, and the rules of any other common carrier applicable to the mode of transportation. Unitized loads shall be designed to assure stability in stacking and storage.

5.4 Marking. Containers and unitized loads shall be marked in accordance with DOT and any other applicable regulatory requirements, and in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Each container shall be marked to show the lot or batch number and date of manufacture of the sodium azide, and the following precautionary marking:

HAZARDS:

Highly Toxic by Ingestion
Highly Toxic by Inhalation
Unstable Explosive

DANGER: MAY BE FATAL IF SWALLOWED OR INHALED
FORMS EXPLOSION-SENSITIVE MATERAL

Avoid contact with solid or dust.
Keep people away.
Do not breathe dust.
Use only with adequate ventilation.
Wash thoroughly after handling.
Wash clothing before reuse.

POISON

Call a Physician

FIRST AID:

If swallowed call a physician. If victim is conscious, have victim drink water or milk and have victim induce vomiting by sticking finger down throat. Never give anything by mouth to an unconscious victim. If unconscious or having convulsions, do nothing except call a physician and keep victim warm.

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If inhaled, call a physician. Remove victim to fresh air. If breathing is difficult, give oxygen. If breathing has stopped, give artificial respiration.

If in eyes or on skin, flush affected area with plenty of water.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Grade A sodium azide is intended for use as a bacteriostatic agent in biological media. Grade B sodium azide is intended for use as an intermediate for the production of lead azide.

6.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification,
(b) Grade of sodium azide required (see 1.2), and
(c) Level of unit packing and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2), and
(d) Quantity of sodium azide required for level C unit pack (see 5.1.2).

6.3 Batch. A batch is defined as that quantity of material which has been manufactured by some unit chemical process or subjected to some physical mixing operation intended to make the final product substantially uniform.

6.4 Significant places. For the purpose of determining conformance with this specification, an observed or calculated value should be rounded off "to the nearest unit" in the last right-hand place of figures used in expressing the limiting value, in accordance with the rounding-off method of ASTM E29.

6.5 Sampling and testing precautions. This specification covers inspection of chemical material (sodium azide and hydrazoic acid, the reaction product with acids) which are potentially hazardous to personnel. Exposure to low concentrations of sodium azide or hydrazoic acid can cause severe headache, dizziness, and ultimate fainting. Although sodium azide is relatively stable, it forms highly sensitive explosive compounds with metals such as lead, silver, mercury, and copper. Samples and solutions containing sodium azide must never be thrown into a sink until the azide content has been destroyed by an acid solution of sodium nitrite in a fume hood. Rags, filter papers, and similar materials contaminated with sodium azide should be treated in a similar manner. Apparatus and equipment contaminated during the analysis of sodium azide should be soaked in an acid solution of sodium nitrite in a fume hood prior to washing and use for other purposes. All applicable rules, regulations, and procedures must be followed in the handling and processing of these materials.

6.6 Ammonium hexa-nitrate cerate. Ammonium hexa-nitrate cerate is available from G. Frederick Smith Co., Columbus, Ohio.

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6.7 Ortho-Phenanthroline indicator. Ortho-Phenanthroline indicator is available from chemical supply houses as o-phenanthroline ferrous sulfate complex. It is also sold by G. Frederick Smith Co., Columbus, Ohio, under the trade name of "Ferroin".

Custodians:

Army - EA

Review activities:

Army - MD
DLA - GS

Preparing activity:

Army - EA

Project No. 6810-B384

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions -- Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-S-20552B	SODIUM AZIDE, TECHNICAL (METRIC)

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION

b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*

4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*

- ☐ VENDOR
- ☐ USER
- ☐ MANUFACTURER
- ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation.

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* -- Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* -- Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* -- Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorizati to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

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